

COUNTIF Function

What is COUNTIF?

COUNTIF counts cells that meet a specific condition.

Think of it as:

"Count only the cells that match my condition."

Syntax

=COUNTIF(range,criteria)

Parameters

Part	Meaning
range	Cells to check
criteria	Condition to match

Example 1: Count "Pass" Students

Create this table:

Result
Pass
Fail
Pass
Pass

Fail

Formula:

=COUNTIF(A2:A6,"Pass")

Result

3

Because "Pass" appears 3 times.

B6 ▾  =COUNTIF(A2:A6,"Pass")			
	A	B	C
1	Result		
2	Pass		
3	Fail		
4	Pass		
5	Pass		
6	Fail	3	
7			

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Example 2: Count "Fail" Students

Formula:

=COUNTIF(A2:A6,"Fail")

Result:

2

B7 =COUNTIF(A2:A6,"Fail")			
	A	B	C
1	Result		
2	Pass		
3	Fail		
4	Pass		
5	Pass		
6	Fail	3	
7		2	
8			

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Example 3: Count Sales Greater Than 10000

Sales

12000

8000

15000

9000

20000

Formula:

=COUNTIF(A2:A6,">10000")

Result

3

Because:

- 12000
- 15000

- 20000 ✓

B6		 =COUNTIF(A2:A6,">10000")	
	A	B	C
1	Sales		
2	12000		
3	8000		
4	15000		
5	9000		
6	20000	3	
7			
8			

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Example 4: Count Marks Below 50

Marks

85

45

72

35

90

Formula:

=COUNTIF(A2:A6,"<50")

Result:

2

(45 and 35)

B6		fx =COUNTIF(A2:A6,"<50")	
	A	B	C
1	Marks		
2	85		
3	45		
4	72		
5	35		
6	90	2	
7			
8			

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Real MIS Example

Employee Status

Achieved

Not Achieved

Achieved

Achieved

Not Achieved

Formula:

=COUNTIF(A2:A6,"Achieved")

Result:

3

This helps managers quickly know how many employees achieved their targets.

B6 ▾ <i>fx</i> =countif(A2:A6,"Achieved")			
	A	B	C
1	Employee Status		
2	Achieved		
3	Not Achieved		
4	Achieved		
5	Achieved		
6	Not Achieved	3	
7			
8			

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Common Criteria

Condition	Formula Example
Equal to	"Pass"
Greater than	">100"
Less than	"<50"
Greater than or equal	">=5000"
Less than or equal	"<=1000"
Not equal	"<>Fail"

Practice Exercise

Create:

Status

Present

Absent

Present

Present

Absent

Present

Formula:

=COUNTIF(A2:A7,"Present")

Expected Result:

4

B7		fx =COUNTIF(A2:A7,"Present")	
	A	B	C
1	Status		
2	Present		
3	Absent		
4	Present		
5	Present		
6	Absent		
7	Present	4	
8			

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What is the difference between COUNT and COUNTIF?

COUNT

Counts all numeric cells

COUNTIF

Counts cells matching a condition

Example:

=COUNT(A2:A10)

Example:

=COUNTIF(A2:A10,"Pass")